PORTFOLIO PROJECT · REAL DATA: CITY OF TORONTO OPEN DATA, 2023 TO 2025

Toronto 311: where do requests go unresolved?

Start here: the question, the headline numbers, and how to use this report.

The question: Where does the city leave requests unresolved, and what is behind the growth in 311 demand?

Reset filters

Growth in requests

2025: 500,269 requests vs 437,043 in 2024

+14.47%

Parks & forestry open

Others: 1.37% to 6.60%

49.45%

Requests on renamed types

of 2025 requests

58.17%

Requests, 2023 to 2025

500,269 in 2025

1,351,594

What the data shows

- Requests grew 14.47% in 2025, to 500,269, but type names changed that year, so growth by type is not comparable.
- Parks, Forestry & Environment has 49.45% of its 2025 requests recorded as open, against 1.37% to 6.60% in every other division.
- 58.17% of 2025 requests sit under type names that are new since January 2025.

What I would do

- Audit the old open parks and forestry requests and publish expected waits for pruning and tree removal.
- Add a closed date to the open dataset so time to close can be measured.
- Publish a mapping table whenever request types are renamed, so year-over-year comparisons stay possible.

How to use this report

- Use the page tabs. Overview shows demand per month; Outcomes compares divisions; Request types shows what residents ask for.
- On Outcomes, right-click a division bar and choose Drill through, then Division detail, to see its request types.
- The Year filter carries across pages (it opens on 2025). Reset filters clears every slicer.

About the data and model

- Source: City of Toronto Open Data, 311 Service Requests, 2023 to 2025: 1,351,594 requests, summarised to 295,239 monthly rows.
- Star schema: one fact table of monthly counts, with Date, Division, Request type and Status dimensions.
- There is no close date. Open means status Open or In Progress when the data was taken.

Footnote: the data has no close date, so I report request status as of the data snapshot, not how long requests took. An open status can mean a real backlog or a status that was never updated.

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Toronto 311: demand is rising, and some requests stay open

1.35 million customer-initiated requests, 2023 to 2025, and what happened to them.

Year (default 2025)

2025

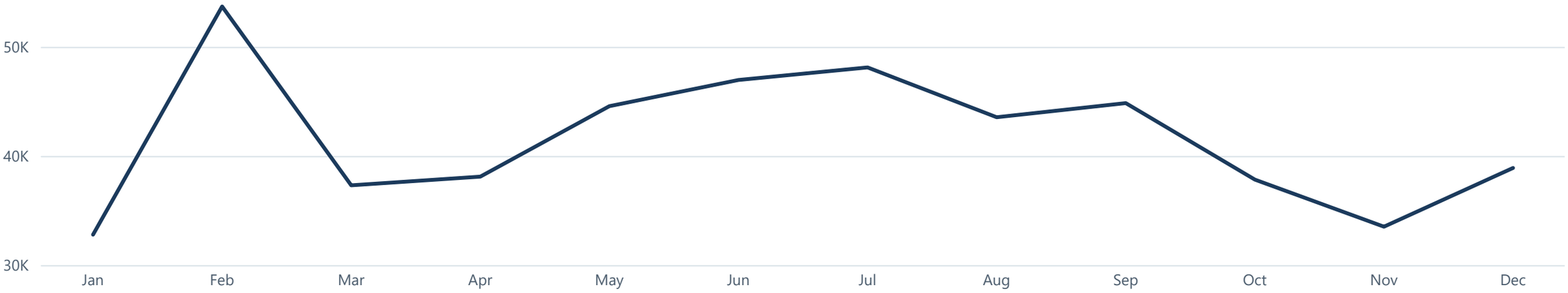
In 2025, requests rose 14.47% to 500,269; 7.77% are recorded as open.

Reset filters

Requests	Resolved	Recorded as open	Parks & forestry open
▲ 14.47% vs 2024	of 2025 requests	of 2025 requests	▲ 45.07 pts vs rest
500,269	80.52%	7.77%	49.45%

Requests per month

The selected year by month. Reset filters to compare all three years.



01 · Demand

+14.47%

Requests rose from 437,043 in 2024 to 500,269 in 2025. The busiest month was February 2025, with 53,707.

02 · The February spike

53,707

February 2025 had 53,707 requests against 24,871 a year earlier, and 19,876 of them were snow types that only exist from January 2025.

03 · Read with care

Labels changed

Type names changed in January 2025, so the rise cannot be split into more problems and new labels.

Footnote: requests per month cover every status. Open means status Open or In Progress at the data snapshot. The Year slicer opens on 2025, and the headline and cards follow it.

Data: City of Toronto Open Data, 311 Service Requests (Open Government Licence - Toronto). No close date in the data. Not an official City report.

Data through Dec 2025

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Half of parks and forestry requests are recorded as open

Share of requests by outcome, by division. Use the year filter to compare years.

Year (default 2025)

2025

2025: Parks, Forestry & Environment has the highest share recorded as open, 49.45% (lowest 1.37%).

Reset filters

Highest open share
Parks, Forestry & Environment
49.45%

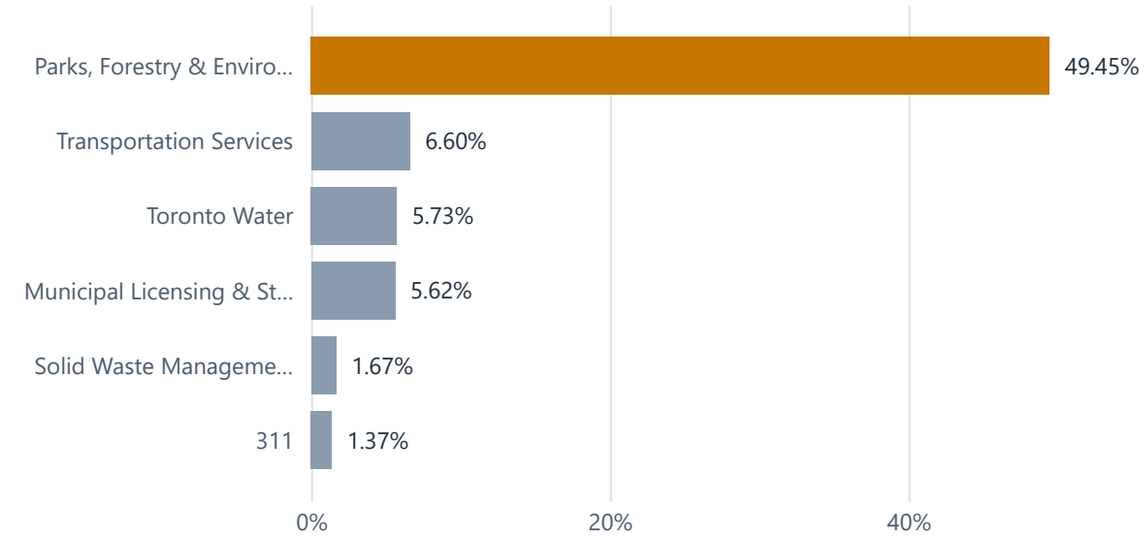
Lowest open share
311
1.37%

Largest division
170,443 requests, 1.67% recorded as open
Solid Waste Management Services

Cancelled
of 2025 requests
10.33%

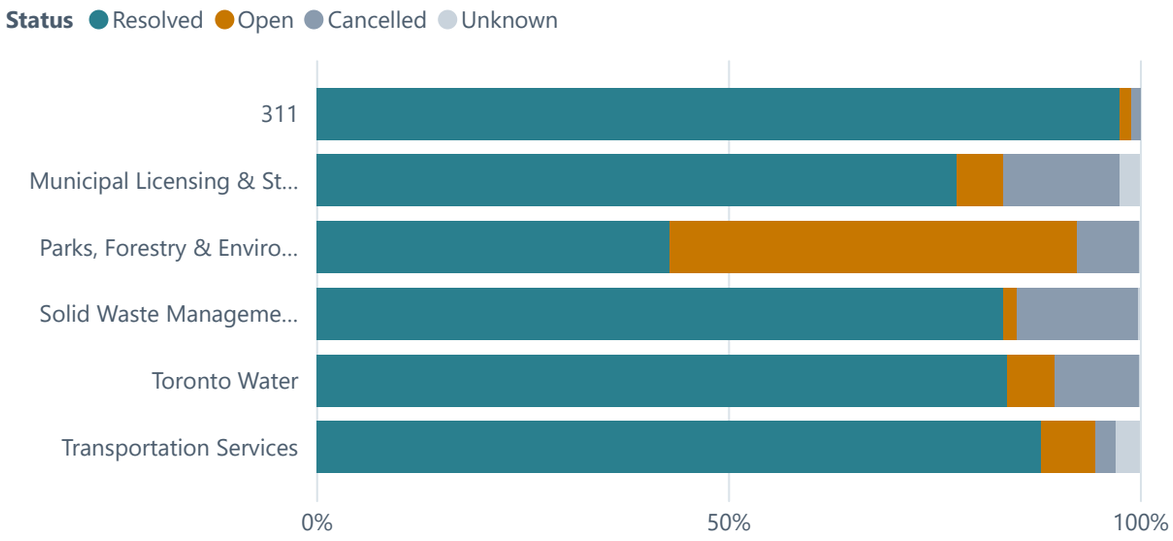
Recorded as open, by division

Parks, forestry and environment stands apart from every other division.



Outcome mix by division

Most divisions resolve nine in ten requests.



Division scorecard

Volume and outcome shares for the selected year. Right-click a division on the bar chart and choose Drill through.

Division	Requests	Resolved %	Cancelled %	Open %
311	7,690	97.57%	1.07%	1.37%
Municipal Licensing & Standards	117,630	77.80%	14.11%	5.62%
Parks, Forestry & Environment	37,611	42.93%	7.55%	49.45%
Solid Waste Management Services	170,443	83.47%	14.72%	1.67%
Toronto Water	36,839	83.91%	10.30%	5.73%
Transportation Services	130,056	88.02%	2.51%	6.60%
Total	**500,269**	**80.52%**	**10.33%**	**7.77%**

01 · Parks and forestry

49.45%

Parks, Forestry & Environment has 18,597 of its 37,611 requests in 2025 recorded as open. Every other division is between 1.37% and 6.60%.

02 · Not a new spike

44.66%

The same division was 44.66% open in 2023 and 51.52% in 2024, so the gap is not new.

03 · Read with care

Open at snapshot

Open means status Open or In Progress when the data was taken. With no close date, it cannot tell a real backlog from a status nobody updated.

Footnote: open means status Open or In Progress at the data snapshot. The data cannot tell a genuine backlog from a status that was never updated, because it has no close date.

Data: City of Toronto Open Data, 311 Service Requests (Open Government Licence - Toronto). No close date in the data. Not an official City report.

Data through Dec 2025

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What people ask 311 for, and a naming change to watch

Largest request types for the selected year, era and division.

Year (default 2025): 2025

Taxonomy era: All

Division: All

Pick one era to compare type counts.

Reset filters

Largest request type
24,448 requests, 4.89% of the selection
Residential Bin Lid Damaged

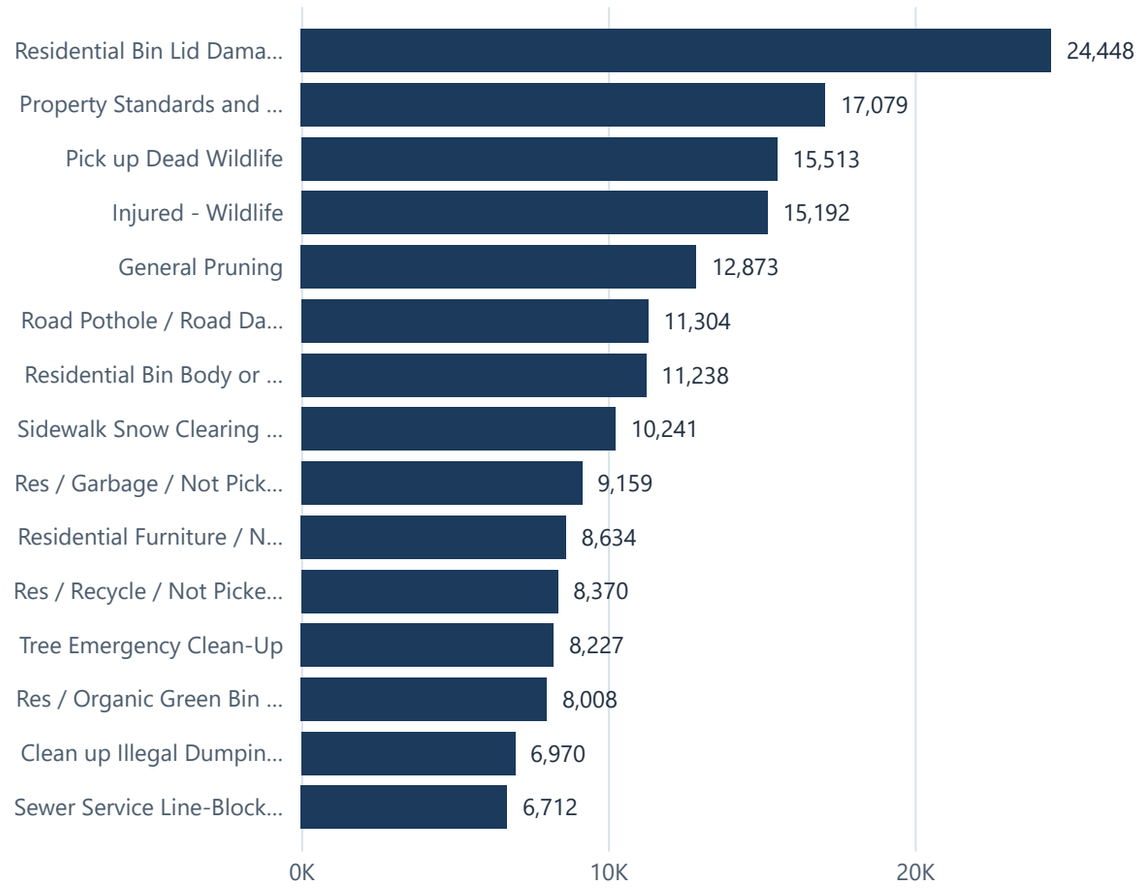
Cancelled
of 2025 requests
10.33%

Most-cancelled type
Types with 1,000 or more requests
57.16%

Type names in both periods
284 of 829 type names
34.26%

Top request types

The 15 largest request types for the selection.



Request types in detail

The 15 largest types. Some are cancelled far more often than others.

Service Type	Requests	Cancelled %	Open %
Residential Bin Lid Damaged	24,448	2.35%	2.16%
Property Standards and Maintenance Violations	17,079	7.18%	15.72%
Pick up Dead Wildlife	15,513	38.84%	0.01%
Injured - Wildlife	15,192	14.11%	0.01%
General Pruning	12,873	7.12%	71.02%
Road Pothole / Road Damage	11,304	3.25%	1.25%
Residential Bin Body or Handle Damaged	11,238	2.67%	1.98%
Sidewalk Snow Clearing Required	10,241	0.77%	0.49%
Res / Garbage / Not Picked Up	9,159	26.72%	0.36%
Residential Furniture / Not Picked Up	8,634	23.67%	0.10%
Res / Recycle / Not Picked Up	8,370	28.57%	0.08%
Tree Emergency Clean-Up	8,227	5.76%	37.04%
Res / Organic Green Bin / Not Picked Up	8,008	20.13%	0.09%
Clean up Illegal Dumping on City Road Allowance	6,970	28.02%	0.04%
Sewer Service Line-Blocked	6,712	4.77%	2.28%

01 · The largest type

24,448

Residential Bin Lid Damaged is the largest request type in 2025, with 24,448 requests (4.89% of all).

02 · Cancellations

57.16%

A yard-waste type with 1,055 requests is the most cancelled. Among larger types, dead-wildlife pick-up is cancelled 38.84% of the time.

03 · Names changed

34.26%

Only 284 of 829 type names (34.26%) appear in both 2023-24 and 2025, so compare type counts only within a period.

Footnote: in January 2025, 255 request type names changed or were introduced, covering 58.17% of 2025 requests. Compare type counts only within 2023 to 2024, or within 2025.

Data: City of Toronto Open Data, 311 Service Requests (Open Government Licence - Toronto). No close date in the data. Not an official City report.

Data through Dec 2025

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Before any analysis: what each number in the file means

What the file contains, what changed in 2025, and what I did about it.

What each year contains

Requests and outcome shares by year, for every division.

Year	Requests	Resolved %	Cancelled %	Open %
2023	414,282	77.62%	11.51%	9.72%
2024	437,043	77.85%	10.78%	9.35%
2025	500,269	80.52%	10.33%	7.77%
Total	**1,351,594**	**78.77%**	**10.84%**	**8.88%**

Request type names by period

Names that exist in only one period make year-over-year comparisons by type invalid.

Type name period	Type names	Requests	Share of requests
2023-24 only	291	469,093	34.71%
2025 only	254	290,985	21.53%
In both periods	284	591,516	43.76%
Total	**829**	**1,351,594**	**100.00%**

What I found in the file and what I did

- The extract has 1,351,594 requests. About 8% of the raw rows were broken by an unquoted comma in a text field, so I repaired them before counting.
- There is no close date. Open means status Open or In Progress when the data was taken, not a confirmed backlog, and time to close cannot be measured.
- Type names changed in January 2025: 255 names appear only in 2025 and cover 58.17% of that year's requests. Growth by type is not comparable across the boundary.
- Statuses are grouped into Resolved, Cancelled, Open and Unknown. The model counts 254 renamed types, not 255, because two spellings differ only by case.
- Checks: totals, yearly counts and open share by division match the SQL queries.

Terms in plain language

- 311: Toronto's city line for non-emergency service requests.
- Open: status Open or In Progress when the data was taken.
- Division: the city department that handles the request.
- Taxonomy era: whether a request type name existed before January 2025, only after it, or in both periods.
- Customer-initiated: requests residents and businesses made, not work the city started itself.